

9.3.2 PHPBB (PHP Bulletin Board)

Like vBulletin, PHPBB is PHP-based, as the name suggests. It is also open source, meaning improvements are always a work in progress. Flexibility in the backend is a plus point for PHPBB, wherein a gamut of choices are available from the now familiar MySQL, to MS SQL or even Access/ODBC database servers.

The best part of PHPBB is that it's a free download; we've saved you the trouble—find it on this month's DVD. After downloading it, unpack and copy and paste the entire “PHPBB” folder to your “www” folder. You can now type in “<http://localhost/phpBB/install/install.php>”, and the



PHPBB installation is a snap

setup will initialise. PHPBB installation is very fast—no lengthy steps. All you need to do is enter the data as we have done in the screenshot above and click Start Install. Once it's installed you need to log in, for which you will be prompted for the Administrator username and password.

There is a mod for PHPBB called EasyMOD—a must-have if your forum runs on PHPBB, because it simplifies the installation of further mods, by replacing the interface with an ease-to-use graphical interface.

Once you get the install window alongside, select “This is a Windows Server”, since our web server is on the same machine as our database, so no FTP is required. Selecting FTP will bring up another window, where the FTP settings need to be entered.



EasyMOD eases the installation of later mods

Note that the window shown to the right on the next page is an alternative to the one on the left; if you choose “I have ftp access to